

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E6LY04 | Year 6 | Complex Texts, Perspective & Sustained Argument

**LEARNING INTENTION**  
I am learning to analyse complex texts by examining perspective, evaluating evidence and constructing sustained, well-reasoned arguments.

**READING STRATEGY**  
Identify the author's perspective and purpose. Evaluate the quality of evidence. Consider whose voice is missing. Challenge assumptions and construct your own reasoned position.

**READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!**

By 2050, the world must feed an estimated 9.7 billion people — two billion more than today — on a planet being **destabilised** by climate change.

Rising temperatures, **unpredictable** rainfall and extreme weather events are **threatening** crop yields on every continent.

In Australia, the **agricultural** sector has already experienced billion-dollar losses due to drought, flood and **biosecurity** threats.

Scientists are developing **drought-resistant** crops using genetic modification — a **technology** that remains deeply **controversial**.

Other solutions include **vertical farming** (growing food in stacked indoor layers), lab-grown meat and precision **fermentation**.

Critics argue these **techno-fixes** distract from the real issue: global food systems are **inequitable**, with one billion people hungry while another billion are obese.

Addressing food security requires not just **innovation**, but fundamental changes to how food is **distributed**, priced and valued.

The solutions exist — what is lacking is the **political will** to implement them.

- VOCABULARY HELPER**
- destabilised** = made unsafe or unstable
  - biosecurity** = measures to prevent the spread of disease
  - drought-resistant** = able to survive with very little water
  - inequitable** = unfair and not giving everyone an equal share
  - political will** = the commitment of leaders to take action on an issue

**WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ**

Where does your food come from? How many countries are involved in producing your typical dinner? Write 2 sentences:

\_\_\_\_\_

- A — COMPREHENSION**
- What is the challenge facing food production by 2050?  
\_\_\_\_\_
  - Name 3 new food technologies mentioned:  
\_\_\_\_\_
  - What do critics say about techno-fixes?  
\_\_\_\_\_

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept personal reflection about food origins.

A1. Feeding 9.7 billion people on a climate-destabilised planet. A2. Drought-resistant crops/GM, vertical farming, lab-grown meat, precision fermentation — any 3. A3. They distract from the real issue: food systems are inequitable. A4. Political will.

B1. 'Techno-fixes' is loaded — suggests critics view technology as superficial band-aids rather than real solutions. Not neutral. B2. '1 billion hungry while another billion are obese' — powerfully illustrates inequity through stark contrast; makes the abstract concrete.

C: Final sentence: both hopeful (solutions exist) and cynical (political will is lacking) — creates urgency. Compound adjectives: drought-resistant, lab-grown, techno-fixes — any one with explanation.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓  
Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:



EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Write a report presenting 3 different solutions to food insecurity. For each solution, explain what it is, its advantages and its limitations. Conclude with a recommendation.

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

PARENT TIP

Plan and cook a meal together using only locally grown or Australian-made ingredients. Discuss: 'What would we eat if we could only eat local food?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to Geography and Science. Students map the global food system for one meal. Debate: technology vs systemic change. Students write a recommendation to a fictional government committee.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- [ ] I can identify loaded language and explain its effect
- [ ] I can evaluate the effectiveness of statistical evidence
- [ ] I can write a sustained argument with a clear and justified position